25901532 – Answer Key

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026
Fourth SEMESTER
Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG4DSCSOC200 - PRINCIPLES OF SOCIAL RESEARCH
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Part A

Short Answer

Answer any **10** questions

Each question carries **3** marks

1. Interpretivist approach focuses on understanding subjective meanings individuals attach to social actions.
2. Citation refers to acknowledging sources of information used in research work.
3. Probability sampling is a method where each unit has a known chance of selection.
4. Narrative analysis studies stories to understand lived experiences and meanings.
5. Systematic inquiry is an organized and methodical investigation to generate knowledge.
6. Voluntary participation means respondents take part in research without coercion.
7. A research problem is a clearly defined issue that guides a study.
8. Experimental group is the group exposed to the independent variable.
9. Data editing involves checking and correcting collected data for accuracy.
10. Value neutrality means maintaining objectivity and avoiding bias in research.
11. Social research is systematic, empirical, and logical in nature.
12. Operationalization converts abstract concepts into measurable variables.
13. Structured interview uses pre-set questions asked in a fixed order.

Part B

Short Answer

Answer all questions

Each question carries **8** marks

14. A research report presents findings in a systematic and structured manner. It includes methodology, analysis, and conclusions based on evidence.
15. Fieldwork often faces issues such as access, bias, and ethical challenges. Time, resources, and respondent cooperation also affect data collection.
16. Empiricism emphasizes knowledge based on observation and experience. It forms the foundation of scientific research.
17. Proper referencing ensures academic credibility and transparency. It also helps avoid plagiarism and acknowledges sources.
18. A questionnaire is self-administered, whereas an interview schedule is conducted by the researcher. They differ in flexibility, interaction, and depth of responses.